HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I've given up on letting people in."

✦ ✦ ✦

Check one choice in each section or write your own. Choose a question and a truth that feel meaningful to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it from 0% to 100%.

> "I've given up on letting people in." I believe this _____ %.

2 My best question

Select a question to ask when you catch yourself thinking, "I've given up on letting people in."

- ☐ What happened that led me to stop trying?
- ☐ Was there a time I let someone in and it went well, even a little?
- ☐ What have I lost since I closed the door?
- ☐ Is it possible to open it only a crack and only for someone safe?
- ☐ What does it mean that God does not break a bruised reed?
- ☐ What would my life look like with one safe friend?

My own question:

3 My replacement truth

Select a balanced statement to practice.

- ☐ God is gentle with bruised hearts.
- ☐ I can open the door a little at a time.
- ☐ Hope can be rebuilt slowly.
- ☐ One safe person is a beginning.
- ☐ Giving up was protection, and I can choose differently.
- ☐ God heals the brokenhearted.

In my own words:

4 My Scripture

Choose one passage to remember; these are the same passages shown on the card.

- ☐ Isaiah 42:3
  "A bruised reed He will not break and a smoldering wick He will not extinguish; He will faithfully bring forth justice."
- ☐ Proverbs 13:12
  "Hope deferred makes the heart sick, but desire fulfilled is a tree of life."
- ☐ Psalm 147:3
  "He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds."
- ☐ Ecclesiastes 4:9
  "Two are better than one, because they have a good return for their labor."

☐ Matthew 11:28
“Come to Me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest.”

The verse I will practice:

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 Rehearse the truth daily

Read your chosen Scripture, listen, and practice a balanced thought.

Read Pearls: Hopeless. Listen to Overcoming Depression. Say your replacement truth aloud once in the morning and once in the evening.

Today I noticed this change:

6 Try a small behavioral experiment

Choose a safe, low-risk test; do not ignore real warning signs.

- ☐ List three times someone showed you kindness, and note how it felt.
- ☐ Say hello to one person you would usually avoid, and stay for a minute.
- ☐ Send a short message to someone you have not spoken to in a while.
- ☐ Accept a small invitation, and stay a short, set time.
- ☐ Spend a few minutes noticing something good about one person.
- ☐ Write a prayer asking God to bring one safe person into your life.

My prediction:

What actually happened:

What I learned:

7 Track what changes

Practice for seven days. Mark what you tried and rate belief strength.

Day	What I practiced	Belief %	What I learned
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			

Song reflection

After listening to one of the four songs, write a sentence about being held, healed, and given hope.

Song:

A truth I want to remember:

My Truth Card

OLD BELIEF:
~~I've given up on letting people in.~~

NEW TRUTH:
God is gentle with my bruised heart. I can open the door a little, to someone safe, and let Him restore what I thought was lost.

MY SCRIPTURE:
Isaiah 42:3

A short prayer

Lord, thank You for being gentle with me. Give me courage to open the door a little, and bring safe people into my life. Amen.

Scripture quotations: Berean Standard Bible (BSB), public domain. Educational material only; not a diagnosis or substitute for professional care.